

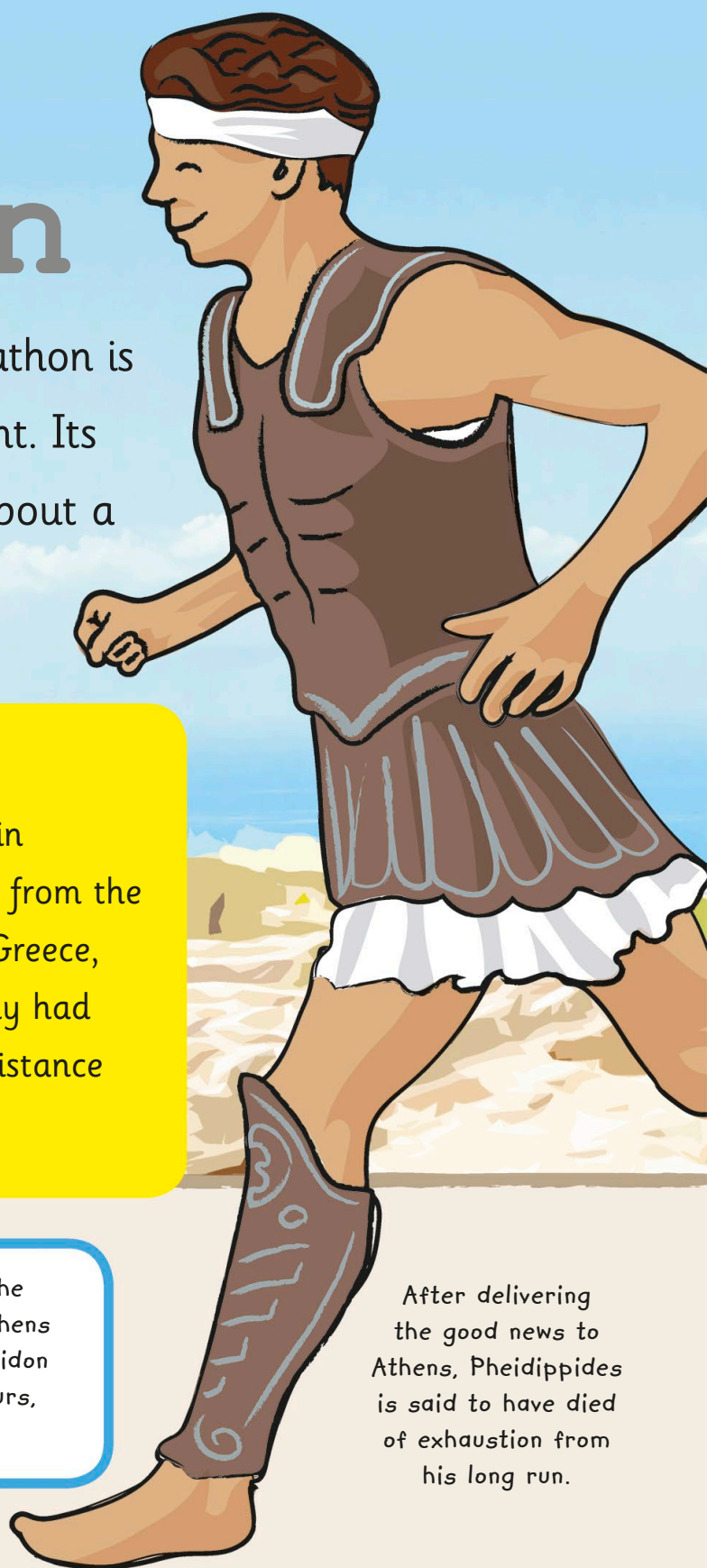


The first marathon

At 26.22 miles (42.2km), the marathon is the **longest** track and field event. Its name comes from a Greek story about a soldier named **Pheidippides**.

Battle news

According to an ancient Greek legend, in **490 BCE**, Pheidippides ran all the way from the battlefield of **Marathon** to Athens, Greece, to let the city know that the Greek army had defeated its enemy. He ran the entire distance of around **25 miles (40km)**.



A marathon was held at the first modern Olympics in Athens in 1896. Greek athlete Spyridon Louis won the race in 2 hours, 58 minutes, 50 seconds.

After delivering the good news to Athens, Pheidippides is said to have died of exhaustion from his long run.